11 Make sure the piece is fundamentally sound before you continue cutting the void to achieve the desired winged outline. A 13mm bowl gouge is fine for this project as you don't want to take too big a cut at any one time. When you start tuning a lot of air, it's important to follow the line of your 'bowl' smoothly, and not to 'fall' into any of the gaps. At this stage you may find it beneficial to use a heavy curved scraper in a shear cutting action to help you obtain a smooth profile. Use a scraper presented in a pronounced trailing position to minimise the potential for a catch

12 If you are unable to complete turning green wood in one session, and you need to leave it for any period of time you need to find a way of stopping the wood drying too quickly, especially from the newly cut endgrain. Use masking tape to temporarily seal the wood to help prevent distortion from uneven drying

13 To release the blank from the faceplate I find it easiest to saw off the attachment points. This reduces the wood you need to turn away later and, in my case, it ensured that I got rid of the remnants of the broken screw from my first failed mounting attempt

14 To support the inside of the bowl well, so that the wings can be turned as thin as possible, use a cork covered MDF faceplate. Prepare a section in the centre to take a raised block that will touch the bottom of the bowl

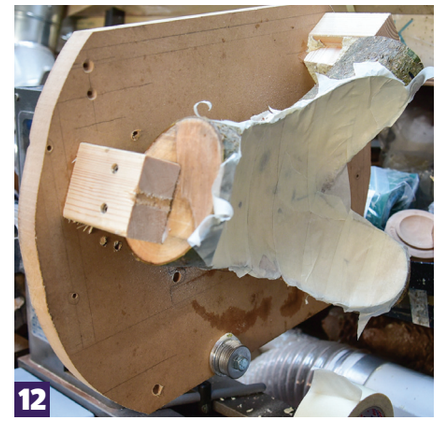
15 To ensure good support for the wings, undercut the edge of the MDF behind the cork, until both the wings and the centre of the bowl touch firmly when pressure is applied by the live centre

16 Use a cork-faced pad so as to not mark the bottom of your turning with the live centre. And, mindful of the extremities that you might not be able to see clearly at the moment, mark these on your toolrest before you start turning the bottom

17 Turning is now very hit and miss, with lots of air between the 'wings'. You need to concentrate on moving the gouge smoothly to create the shape you want, ignoring the temptation to cut deeper as the resistance decreases when you get nearer the tips. Keep stopping the lathe to check your progress

18 It's very difficult to see the small extremities of the wings when turning, so just keep the gouge moving in your chosen arc until the clicking sound stops

11


12

13

14

15

16

17

18

WT_291_61_65_HOLLY_CROTCH_BOWL_NEW.indd 64 03/03/2016 15:02